

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

TUESDAY, JULY 14, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVIII NO. 11

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 52498.64 ▼ 138.37 0.26%

NASDAQ 25873.18 ▼ 1.6%

STOXX 600 641.01 ▼ 0.01%

10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 10/32, yield 4.610%

OIL \$78.14 ▲ \$6.73

GOLD \$3,997.00 ▼ \$107.10

EURO \$1.1383

YEN 162.46

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **A coalition of 12 states** led by California is suing to block Paramount's \$81 billion acquisition of Warner Bros. Discovery, presenting the biggest obstacle for the deal. **A1**

◆ **Volkswagen said** it might have to cut 50,000 more jobs in a renewed drive to bring costs into line with those of other big carmakers. **B1**

◆ **Gold is down** about 25% from its record high in January, including a 2.6% slide on Monday. The Nasdaq fell about 1.6%, the Dow declined 0.3% and the S&P 500 lost 0.8%. **B1**

◆ **Intel said it plans** to invest \$5.71 billion to expand its manufacturing site in Ireland, part of the company's latest effort to meet growing demand for AI and high-performance chips. **B3**

◆ **Shein has cleared** a key hurdle for its long-awaited Hong Kong IPO, winning China's nod for a listing that could see it valued at more than \$40 billion. **B3**

◆ **Lawson Whiting**, the CEO of Brown-Forman, is planning to step down, as the Jack Daniel's maker seeks to move past a slowdown in alcohol sales. **B3**

◆ **Meta has scaled up** the size of its massive data-center project in Northeast Louisiana to 5 gigawatts of compute capacity and said it would now cost more than \$50 billion. **B4**

◆ **The United Arab Emirates** boosted crude output by 80% in June from the previous month after quitting OPEC to escape production quotas and bring oil to the market on its own terms. **B9**

Worldwide

◆ **President Trump said** he is reimposing the U.S. blockade on Iranian shipping, escalating a standoff over control of the Strait of Hormuz, and the U.S. launched a third consecutive night of strikes on Iran. **A1**

◆ **Tit-for-tat attacks** between Yemen and Saudi Arabia threaten to scuttle a truce and expand the war in the Middle East. **A8**

◆ **Trump and his family** acted in bad faith in bringing a \$10 billion lawsuit against the IRS, a federal judge ruled in a rebuke of the president, his attorneys and the DOJ. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** is pushing to limit undocumented immigrants' access to the U.S. banking system, requiring banks to consider loans to them as potentially risky. **A3**

◆ **A federal immigration** officer fatally shot one person during an enforcement operation in Biddeford, Maine, authorities said. **A3**

◆ **A federal appeals court** revived more than 500 lawsuits that allege Tylenol and generic acetaminophen can cause ADHD or autism if taken during pregnancy. **A3**

◆ **South Carolina Gov.** Henry McMaster named Darline Graham, the sister of the late Sen. Lindsey Graham, to serve as an interim replacement in the Senate. **A6**

◆ **European authorities** imposed sanctions on Russian intelligence units and hackers, accusing them of a 15-year campaign targeting governments and critical infrastructure across the Continent. **A7**

◆ **Died: Sam Neill**, 78, star of "Jurassic Park." **A7**

CONTENTS Markets Digest... B7
Arts in Review... A12
Business & Finance... B2
Business News... B3
Crossword... A12
Heard on Street... B10
Markets... B9

Opinion... A13-15
Personal Journal A10-11
Sports... A16
Technology... B4
U.S. News... A2-4,6
World News... A7-9



© 2026 Dow Jones & Company, Inc.
All Rights Reserved

Thailand Seeks Answers in Deadly Bar Fire



TRAGIC AFTERMATH: Bodies are removed Monday from the Rong Beer Na Ladprao bar in Bangkok, where at least 27 people died in a fire. Most of the victims were found in windowless bathrooms, where they might have sought shelter from flames. **A9**

Trump Says He Is Reimposing U.S. Blockade on Iran Shipping

Oil prices leap as Pentagon starts new strikes, president talks of Hormuz tolls

President Trump said he is reimposing the U.S. blockade on Iranian shipping, escalating a standoff over control of the strategic Strait of Hormuz.

His comments on Monday came after the U.S. launched additional strikes against Iran, which defied U.S. demands

that it publicly declare the strait open and instead closed the waterway. Oil prices jumped, with Brent crude trading 9.6% higher.

The U.S. on Monday launched its third consecutive night of strikes on Iran.

U.S. Central Command said the latest round began at 4:45 p.m. Eastern Time to "continue imposing a heavy cost on Iranian forces and degrade their ability to attack innocent civilians and commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz."

By Benoit Faucon,
Rebecca Feng
and Jared Malsin

Trump told conservative radio host Hugh Hewitt that the U.S. was going to hit Iran "very hard" Monday and Tuesday, "and there's not a damn thing they can do about it." Speaking shortly before Monday's attacks began, Trump said the U.S. would strike Pickaxe Mountain, a fortified, underground nuclear

site yet to be targeted since the war began Feb. 28.

Trump asserted that the strait remains open under U.S. protection and said the U.S. would charge 20% of every cargo shipment as compensation for its costs. He didn't detail how that would work but said procedures would be formulated immediately. "I want to be reimbursed because we're

Please turn to page A8

◆ **Nationalism drowns out Iranian diplomats.....** A8

Frequent Oil Draws Tax Strategic Reserve

By BENOÎT MORENNE

The U.S. is tapping into its national stocks of crude with abandon. The withdrawals are taking a toll on the strategic reserve system.

Just in the past four years, the Biden and Trump administrations have ordered the largest releases from the Strategic Petroleum Reserve while seeking to tamp down soaring oil prices—a total of 352 million barrels, or nearly half the capacity of the stocks.

Now, frequent drawdowns, wear-and-tear and a lack of investments are straining the

reserve, according to experts. The 60 Gulf Coast salt caverns that make up the stocks can't be drawn from or refilled at the rate at which they were designed, federal researchers found. Equipment failures have bedeviled the reserve's managers. At one point, a well broke and caused the loss of hundreds of thousands of barrels of crude.

The upshot: President Trump or a future administration might not be able to rely on the massive oil buffer like others have in the past—even as the prolonged U.S.-Iran war all but ensures continued vol-

atility in energy markets.

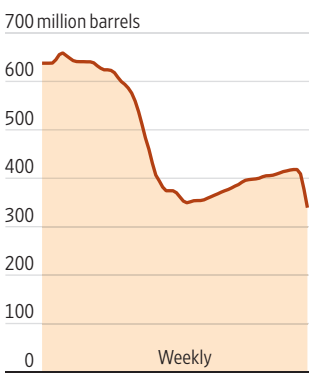
"It's a strategically important national asset, and I think that its management and supervision needs to be elevated to reflect that," said Clayton Seigle, a nonresident scholar in energy security at the Center for Strategic and International Studies.

Renewed tensions between the U.S. and Iran in recent days have raised the specter of potential new constraints on shipping in the Strait of

Please turn to page A8

◆ **U.A.E.'s output surged after it left OPEC.....** B9

U.S. crude oil stocks in the Strategic Petroleum Reserve



Source: U.S. Energy Information Administration

Judge Slams President On His Suit Against IRS

By RICHARD RUBIN
AND C. RYAN BARBER

President Trump and his family acted in bad faith in bringing a \$10 billion lawsuit against the Internal Revenue Service, a federal judge ruled Monday in a scathing rebuke of the president, his attorneys and the Justice Department.

The lawsuit led to Trump's extraordinary agreement in May with his own administration, in which the U.S. moved to create a nearly \$1.8 billion "anti-weaponization fund," and the government promised to cease all pending tax audits of Trump, his family and his businesses. The administration backed off the fund—which had earmarked money for Trump allies who claimed they were wrongly targeted by the government—amid pushback from lawmakers, including Republicans, concerned that it could be used to compensate Trump supporters who stormed the Capitol on

Please turn to page A4

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL

Grass is greener—White-collar men are obsessed with having the perfect lawn. **A10**



BUSINESS & FINANCE

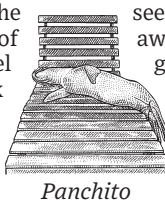
It's the magic number: Why \$9.99 is the price that just makes the most cents. **B1**

On the Galápagos Islands, Animals Always Come First

Sea lions get dibs on loungers and everything stops when an iguana gets hit

By JENNA BELHUMEUR

Approaching our hotel's front desk while on the Galápagos island of Santa Cruz, my travel companion Gidon Ofek and I received some painful news: we needed to leave for our 9 a.m. flight a full



Panchito

three hours early. Looking at our map, we were confused. The airport seemed to be only 30 miles away. The receptionist gently explained the delay: There was one less bus running due to an incident involving a run-over iguana. Please turn to page A11

Lindsey Graham's Final Mission: Saving Ukraine

The South Carolina lawmaker relished a last moment of political triumph

A day before emergency responders arrived at Sen. Lindsey Graham's Capitol Hill home on Saturday night, the South Carolina Republican made what would be his last public appearance, standing outside St. Michael's golden-domed monastery in Kyiv.

By Robbie Gramer,
Vera Bergengruen
and Yoko Kubota

Graham, who had spent months pushing for sanctions legislation he and others believed would force Russia to finally end its four-year assault on Ukraine, described the moment as a chance to marshal support from the U.S. and other global powers to finally end the conflict.

"I've never been more optimistic than I am today," he said Friday after meeting

with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky. "We have a magic moment in time here."

Graham, who had a personal rapport with President Trump, spent his final days in the role of a U.S. power broker that had defined much of his career: meeting foreign leaders, pressing for hawkish U.S. foreign policy and planning to make the rounds on Sunday morning TV news shows.

When Graham landed Saturday in Washington, colleagues said he was tired but elated after a whirlwind of meetings in Europe and Ukraine. He had spent his 71st birthday on the road, buoyed by a NATO summit in Turkey where Trump praised the alliance and em-

Please turn to page A6

◆ **Graham's sister is named to fill his Senate seat.....** A6